



SCANDINAVIA

Scandinavia is the name given to the countries of northern Europe. The far north of this region lies inside the Arctic Circle, so the winters are very harsh.



Sweat it out

Saunas are wooden rooms, steaming with heat from a stove. Invented in Finland more than 1,000 years ago, they are found in many homes in Scandinavia. After a sauna, people often enjoy a cold shower or a roll in the snow.

The people of northern Scandinavia enjoy winter sports in the cold climate. Cross-country skiing was invented in Norway, and is still a quick way of getting around during the snowy winter months.



City slickers

About a quarter of the Danish population live in Copenhagen, the capital of Denmark. Most Scandinavians choose to live in cities in the warmer south of the region.

Escape to the country

Many Scandinavians enjoy a high standard of living. Some can afford to buy or rent a second home in the mountains, in the forest, or by the sea. They escape to these “holiday huts” on weekends and during the summer months.



Lighting up the sky

The northern lights, or aurora borealis, can be seen in many parts of the Arctic Circle, especially the far north of Scandinavia. The colorful, dancing lights appear in the sky when a cloud of gas released from the sun collides with the magnetic field around Earth.

Land of the midnight sun

Imagine waking at midnight, to find the sun shining outside! At the height of summer, Earth's tilt causes northern countries to get more of the sun's light. In northern

Scandinavia, it doesn't get dark at all in the middle of summer.

It is still light at midnight, because the sun hasn't set.

